

The menu bar looked like a primitive version of the Windows Desktop, and clicking on it would provide a list of options similar to the Windows of today. The Navigate menu had things such as “Back”, “Next” and “Previous”, and the last two were useful when you followed a link from a list of links—they meant “go back a step and then take the next link from the same page.”

The “Link” menu had options such as “Mark all” which would remember the URL of the current page where you were. “Mark selection” would make a link target for the selected text, give it an ID, and remember the URL of that fragment. “Link to Marked” would make a link from the current selection to whatever URL you had last marked. So making a link involved browsing to somewhere interesting, hitting [Command] + [M], going to the document you were writing and selecting some text, and then hitting [Command] + [L]. “Link to new” would create a new window and prompt for a URL, and then make a link from the selection to the new document. You never saw the URLs—you could of course always find documents by following the link to them.

Using the “Style” menu, you could load a style sheet to define how you wanted your documents (Web pages) rendered. You could also set the paragraph style to an HTML element’s style such as heading1, heading 2, list element, etc., and then this implied an HTML structure in which the document was written back.

At that time, the “X” close box was unique to NeXT, and according to Tim, Windows copied it. The broken X in the “Tim’s home page” window means that the document was in the process of being edited and was unsaved. Now that we have talked about the first Web browser, let’s move on to find more about other browsers.